18TH & 19TH C

Assessment Question: How has medicine changed from c1250 to the modern day?

Name: ____________________ Class: ____________

Progress & Assessment Tracker	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: KT3.1: What breakthrough discoveries changed our understanding of disease causes?			
L2: KT3.2: How did the Industrial Revolution transform prevention and treatment?			
L3: KT3.3: How significant were Edward Jenner and John Snow?			
Final Unit Grade:			

Section B: Thematic Study (Medicine in Britain)

> *This section tests your understanding of change, continuity, and causation across 800 years of British medicine.*

Question 3: Explain One Similarity or Difference...

4 Marks | 5 mins

5:00

TARGET OBJECTIVE

AO2 (Analyse similarity and difference across historical periods)

THE SYMMETRICAL SPLICING METHOD

[Comparative Thesis] [Era 1: Context]

[Era 2: Matching Context]

Examiner Red Flags

The "Two-Story" Essay: Writing a block of facts about the first era, followed by a

Grade 9 Checklist

Immediate Comparison: Does my very first sentence make a direct comparison separate block about the second era without linking them is capped at 2 marks.

Concept Slippage: If the question asks about prevention, do not write about treatment.

Chronological Blunders: Placing key developments in the wrong century.

using a comparative connective?

Symmetrical Alignment: Do the details I provide for Era 2 directly match the theme of Era 1?

Single-Paragraph Splicing: Is my answer written as a single, cohesive paragraph?

Question 4: Explain Why... (Causation)

12 Marks | 15-18 mins

18:00

TARGET OBJECTIVE

AO2 (Analyse causation) and AO1 (Demonstrate precise knowledge)

THE THREE-CAUSAL-PILLARS LAYOUT

No Introduction

Para 1	Para 2	Para 3
Stimulus A	Stimulus B	Own Knowledge

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No Conclusion
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Examiner Red Flags

The Stimulus Cap: Failing to introduce an independent third factor from your own knowledge caps your mark at 8/12.

The Narrative Biography Trap: Writing a chronological story instead of explaining *why* their work led to rapid progress.

Grade 9 Checklist

The Rule of Three: Have I structured my answer into exactly three separate paragraphs?

Causal Topic Openers: Does the first sentence of each paragraph state a clear, analytical cause?

Double Causal Connectives: Have I used the Edexcel Connective Chain ("Consequently...", "This meant that...") at least twice per paragraph?

Question 5 & 6: Evaluative Essay

16+4 Marks

25-30 mins

30:00

TARGET OBJECTIVE

AO2 (Evaluate significance/change) and AO1 (Wide-ranging knowledge)

THE GRADE 9 JUDGMENT ARC

1. **Intro** (Thesis & Criteria)
2. **FOR** (Given Factor)
3. **AGAINST** (Own Knowledge)
4. **Conclusion** (Apply Criteria)

Examiner Red Flags

The One-Sided Argument: Failing to analyze alternative factors traps your essay at Level 2 (8 marks).

"Fencing" Conclusions: Reaching a conclusion that simply states both sides were equally important.

Concept Slippage: Treating "care" and "treatment" as identical.

Grade 9 Checklist

Explicit Evaluation Criteria: Have I defined the historical criteria I will use to measure the statement?

The Argument AGAINST: Have I evaluated alternative factors using my own knowledge?

Substantiated Verdict: Have I explicitly applied the criteria established in my intro to justify which factor was most significant?

SPaG: Have I capitalized proper nouns and correctly spelled specialist terms?

L1: KT3.1: What breakthrough discoveries changed our understanding of disease causes?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- [ ] Explain the difference between Spontaneous Generation and Germ Theory.
- [ ] Analyze the significance of Robert Koch's scientific methodology in microbiology.

> *In the 18th and 19th centuries, the Industrial Revolution created overcrowded, dirty cities, making epidemic diseases a massive threat. While scientists had finally discarded ancient beliefs like the Four Humours, they incorrectly assumed that rotting dirt created the germs they could now see under microscopes. However, the brilliant experiments of Louis Pasteur and* ***Robert Koch*** *finally solved the mystery of illness, moving medicine into a truly scientific era.*

Did you know?

- 1861: The year the French chemist Louis Pasteur published his Germ Theory, proving microbes in the air cause decay.
- 1882: The year the German doctor Robert Koch successfully identified the specific microbe that caused tuberculosis (TB).
- Spontaneous Generation: The incorrect 18th-century medical theory that rotting matter naturally created microbes, which Pasteur finally proved wrong.

Do Now Activity **Score: / 7**

1. What do historians call the 'Stagnation Paradox' regarding Vesalius and Harvey?

2. What did William Harvey discover about the blood?

3. What did Harvey prove wrong about Galen's theories?

4. In what year was the Great Plague?

5. Explain one way the response to the Great Plague was better than the Black Death.

6. To what extent did Harvey's discovery improve medical treatment in the 1600s?

7. Recall: Who was Andreas Vesalius and what was their key contribution to medicine?

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

Germ Theory | **Spontaneous Generation** | **Bacteriology**

In nineteenth-century Britain, doctors struggled to agree on the causes of disease. Before Pasteur's breakthrough, the prevailing belief was ________________, which claimed that microbes were simply created by decaying matter. However, Pasteur's publication of ________________ in 1861 proved that airborne microbes caused decay and illness. This laid the foundation for the new science of ________________, led by Robert Koch, who developed scientific methods to isolate and stain specific bacteria under powerful microscopes.

Q1. Identify the scientist who published the Germ Theory in 1861.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK (Q3)

How did Pasteur's swan-neck flask experiment disprove the theory of spontaneous generation?

☐ A. It showed that liquids only decayed when exposed to airborne microbes, proving that microbes caused decay (not the other way around).

☐ B. It proved that microbes were killed by intense cold.

☐ C. It showed that diseases were spread by physical contact.

☐ D. It proved that microbes spontaneously appeared in a vacuum.

Q2. Describe what Spontaneous Generation was.

Q4. Explain how Robert Koch developed Pasteur's work.

Q5. Evaluate the significance of the Germ Theory on the history of medicine.

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Which was more significant in transforming British medicine: Louis Pasteur's theoretical proof of Germ Theory in 1861, or Robert Koch's practical scientific methods to identify specific disease-causing microbes in the 1870s and 1880s?

Think: Jot down your choice and one piece of evidence from the sources (e.g., Pasteur disproving spontaneous generation and providing the core principles, vs. Koch growing bacteria on agar jelly, staining them with dyes, and finding the TB and cholera microbes).

Your Notes:

Historian's Corner: The Debate over the Pace of the Germ Theory Revolution

Historians actively debate how quickly Germ Theory transformed medical beliefs in Britain. While traditional narratives present Pasteur's 1861 publication as an overnight revolution that instantly swept away ancient superstitions, modern revisionist historians argue that the transition was incredibly slow and highly contested. They point out that Pasteur was a chemist, not a doctor, and his early work focused on wine and vinegar, leading prominent British medical authorities like Dr. Henry Bastian to reject his ideas for decades. It was only after Robert Koch identified specific human pathogens (such as the tuberculosis microbe in 1882) and developed practical laboratory techniques that the wider medical community gradually accepted the link between germs and disease.

GCSE Exam Practice

Q6. â€˜Louis Pasteur's publication of the Germ Theory was the biggest turning point in understanding the causes of disease.â€™ How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks) You may use the following in your answer:
â€¢ spontaneous generation
â€¢ Robert Koch
You must also use information of your own.

GCSE Exam Practice

Q Explain why Louis Pasteurâ€™s Germ Theory (1861) was a major turning point in medicine. (12 marks)

Q Explain one way in which ideas about the cause of illness in the period c1700â€“c1900 were different from ideas about the cause of illness in the period c1500â€“c1700. (4 marks)

Exam Practice

1. â€˜Louis Pasteurâ€™s publication of the Germ Theory was the biggest turning point in understanding the causes of disease.â€™ How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks)

You may use the following in your answer:

- Spontaneous Generation
- Robert Koch

You must also use information of your own.

General Notes

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L2: KT3.2: How did the Industrial Revolution transform prevention and treatment?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain how hospital care and nursing standards were transformed c1700-c1900 under the influence of Florence Nightingale.
- ☐ Analyse how the breakthroughs of anaesthetics and antiseptics solved the critical surgical problems of pain and infection.
- ☐ Evaluate the role of government intervention in disease prevention through the 1875 Public Health Act.

The 19th century witnessed a dramatic revolution in how society treated the sick and prevented disease. Driven by the devastating impact of industrial slums and the breakthrough of Germ Theory, the government finally abandoned its 'laissez-faire' attitude to enforce public health. Simultaneously, brilliant pioneers transformed terrifying, deadly hospitals and surgical theatres into clean, scientific environments, drastically improving the chances of human survival.

Did you know?

- 15%: The dramatically reduced surgical death rate achieved by Joseph Lister between 1867â€“1870 after he introduced carbolic acid antiseptics.
- 1875: The year the British government passed the compulsory Public Health Act, finally forcing local councils to provide clean water and sewers.
- 1885: The year Louis Pasteur successfully developed the rabies vaccine, the first scientifically manufactured human vaccination.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 6

1. What was 'Spontaneous Generation'?

2. Who published the Germ Theory in 1861?

3. What did Robert Koch contribute to Germ Theory?

4. Why did many doctors reject Germ Theory at first?

5. Explain the significance of Koch's methodology (e.g., staining microbes).

6. Recall: Who was William Harvey and what was their key contribution to medicine?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Laissez-faire | Aseptic surgery | Compulsory

Your Sentence:

KNOWLEDGE CHECK (Q2)

How did Florence Nightingale's 'Notes on Nursing' (1859) help to improve the survival rates of patients in British hospitals?

- ☐ A. It taught nurses how to perform complex internal surgery.
- ☐ B. It established strict protocols for hygiene, ventilation, and cleanliness, drastically reducing infection rates.
- ☐ C. It proved that germs caused disease and taught nurses how to use carbolic acid.
- ☐ D. It taught nurses how to discover new antibiotics.

Q1. Identify the first effective anaesthetic discovered in 1847.

Q3. Describe the state of surgery before 1847.

Q4. Explain how Joseph Lister solved the problem of infection.

Q5. To what extent did Simpson's discovery of Chloroform immediately improve surgery?

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Was the introduction of anaesthetics (James Simpsonâ€™s Chloroform) or antiseptics (Joseph Listerâ€™s Carbolic Acid) a more significant turning point for patients undergoing surgery in the 19th century?

Think: Jot down your choice and one piece of evidence (e.g., Chloroform solved patient pain but initially led to the 'Black Period' of higher death rates, while Carbolic Acid solved postoperative infection and dropped mortality rates from 46% to 15% but relied on Pasteur's Germ Theory).

Your Notes:

Historian's Corner: The Debate over the 'Black Period' of Surgery

Historians frequently debate the immediate consequences of James Simpson's 1847 discovery of chloroform. While popular history often celebrates chloroform as an overnight triumph that ended the horror of conscious amputations, medical historians point out that it ushered in a devastating 'Black Period' for British surgery. Because patients were unconscious and relaxed, surgeons attempted far deeper, more complex, and longer internal operations. However, because Lister's carbolic antiseptics were not introduced until 1865, surgeons still operated in filthy environments with unwashed hands and blood-stained coats. As a result, the 'Black Period' actually saw a dramatic increase in postoperative deaths from gangrene and infection, leading some historians to argue that the discovery of anaesthetics was a step backward for patient survival until antiseptics were finally developed.

GCSE Exam Practice

Q6. â€˜The discovery of Carbolic Acid was the most significant turning point in surgery in the years c1700â€“c1900.â€™ How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks + 4 marks for SPaG)

GCSE Exam Practice

Q Explain why Joseph Listerâ€™s development of carbolic acid was so significant in the history of surgery. (12 marks)

Q Explain one way in which surgical treatments in the period c1700â€“c1900 were different from surgical treatments in the medieval period (c1250â€“c1500). (4 marks)

Exam Practice

> **1. â€˜The discovery of Carbolic Acid was the most significant turning point in surgery in the years c1700â€“c1900.â€™ How far do you agree? Explain your answer. (16 marks + 4 marks for SPaG) (16**

marks)

You may use the following in your answer:

- Joseph Lister
- Chloroform

You must also use information of your own.

General Notes

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L3: KT3.3: How significant were Edward Jenner and John Snow?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain the significance and limitations of Edward Jenner's development of the smallpox vaccine.
- ☐ Analyze how John Snow investigated the 1854 cholera epidemic and assess the significance of his findings.

The 18th and 19th centuries witnessed two monumental breakthroughs in the prevention of deadly diseases. Edward Jennerâ€™s pioneering smallpox vaccination provided the world's first scientifically tested method of immunity, saving millions globally. Decades later, John Snowâ€™s brilliant, logical investigation into cholera proved that lethal epidemics were water-borne, fundamentally shattering the ancient miasma theory. Together, these two men laid the vital foundations for modern public health and immunology.

Did you know?

- 1796: The year Edward Jenner successfully tested the first smallpox vaccination on young James Phipps using cowpox.
- 1852: The year the British government officially made the smallpox vaccination compulsory.
- 1854: The year John Snow mapped the devastating cholera outbreak in Soho, London, proving it was spread by the Broad Street water pump.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 6

1. Who was Florence Nightingale?

2. What did Nightingale believe caused disease?

3. Name the first effective anaesthetic used in surgery (by James Simpson).

4. Explain the difference between anaesthetics and antiseptics.

5. Why did the 'Black Period of Surgery' occur after the discovery of anaesthetics?

6. Recall: Who was Roger Bacon and what was their key contribution to medicine?

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: ***Inoculation***

Q1. Identify the disease Edward Jenner created a vaccine for.

Q2. Describe how Jenner proved his vaccine worked.

Q3. Explain the actions John Snow took during the 1854 Cholera outbreak.

Q4. Evaluate the significance of the 1875 Public Health Act.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK (Q5)

How did John Snow prove that cholera was a waterborne disease in 1854, long before the discovery of germs?

- [ ] A. By looking at the cholera bacteria under a microscope.
- [ ] B. By mapping the deaths around the Broad Street pump, proving the victims shared a water source rather than breathing the same 'bad air'.
- [ ] C. By boiling all the water in London and watching the disease disappear.
- [ ] D. By injecting a cholera vaccine into local residents.

Pair & Share Activity

Prompt: Whose breakthrough was a more significant turning point in the history of disease prevention: Edward Jenner's 1796 discovery of smallpox vaccination, or John Snow's 1854 discovery that cholera was water-borne?

Think: Jot down your choice and one piece of evidence from the sources (e.g., Jenner's vaccine being the first scientific prevention method that eventually wiped out a disease globally, versus Snow proving the link between physical sanitation and disease, which directly paved the way for Bazalgette's sewers and the 1875 Public Health Act).

Your Notes:

Historian's Corner: The Debate over the Catalysts for Victorian Public Health Reform

Historians debate the extent to which John Snow's 1854 Broad Street investigation was the primary driver behind the cleanup of Victorian London. Traditional narratives portray Snow as a lone hero whose pump-handle intervention instantly convinced the government to abandon laissez-faire and build a new sewer system. However, revisionist historians argue that Snow's work had very little immediate impact because the medical establishment and the General Board of Health clung obstinately to miasma theory. They suggest that the real turning point was the combination of 'The Great Stink' of 1858, which physically disrupted Parliament, and the 1867 Reform Act, which gave working-class men the vote and forced politicians to promise sanitary reforms to win elections. This culminated in the compulsory 1875 Public Health Act once Pasteur's Germ Theory finally provided the scientific proof that Snow lacked.

GCSE Exam Practice

Q6. Explain why there was rapid progress in public health in the second half of the nineteenth century (c1850â€“c1900). (12 marks)

GCSE Exam Practice

Q Explain why there was rapid progress in public health during the second half of the 19th century. (12 marks)

Q Explain one way in which the role of the government in preventing disease in the period c1700â€“c1900 was different from the period c1500â€“c1700. (4 marks)

Exam Practice

> **1. Explain why there was rapid progress in public health in the second half of the nineteenth century (c1850â€“c1900). (12 marks)**

You may use the following in your answer:

- John Snow
- The Great Stink

You must also use information of your own.

General Notes

☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

Factors Overview: 18th & 19th C

Edexcel focuses heavily on the factors that drove medical progress (or held it back). For each factor below, write one specific historical example from this period that either helped or hindered medical progress.

Factor	Specific Historical Example & Impact
Individuals	
The Church & Religion	
Government & Wealth	
Science & Technology	
Attitudes in Society	
War	

Factor	Specific Historical Example & Impact